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# Master Glossary

*Every term, acronym, formula, and doctrine from Sections A through K, compiled alphabetically for rapid reference and study.*

|                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                 |
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| <div>L-1</div> <div>How to Use This Glossary</div>                                                                               | <div>A-C</div> <div>Terms A through C</div>                                                                                      | <div>D-F</div> <div>Terms D through F</div>                                                                                     |
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## L.1 · NAVIGATION &amp; STUDY GUIDE

# How to Use This Glossary

*This is the single-source vocabulary for the entire Create The Edge Sales & Proposal Development Training Guide. Every term you encounter across Sections A through K is defined here, cross-referenced to its source module, and organized for three modes of study: browse, search, and drill.*

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## Three Ways to Use This Section

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### 01

## BROWSE MODE

#### Alphabetical Reference

Navigate by letter using the sidebar or nav cards. Each entry shows the term, its category, its definition, and a cross-reference to the module where it appears in context.

### 02

## SEARCH MODE

#### Live Instant Search

Use the search bar in the top navigation to find any term, acronym, formula, or concept instantly. Results highlight the matching text across every entry, quiz question, and callout in this module.

### 03

## DRILL MODE

#### Flashcards & Quiz

The 15-question assessment tests recall and application. The interactive flip cards isolate term-to-definition pairs. Printable cut cards let you study offline with physical cards.

### 04

## CATEGORY TAGS

#### Domain-Coded Entries

Every entry carries a category tag: Proposal, Fee Calc, Sector, Legal, Systems, Sales, Design, or Personnel. Use these to cluster your study by domain rather than alphabet.

🔑 RULE OF THE HOUSE

Definitions in this glossary are drawn verbatim or paraphrased from approved source material: [Department Manager]'s meeting notes, the original Employee Training Manual, the SECTION\_G Proposal Reference, and the master build specification. No term has been invented. Where a rate or formula appears, it traces to the 2026 rate card or the master fee chart. Any figure marked [verify with [Department Manager]] requires confirmation before use in a client document.

Category Key

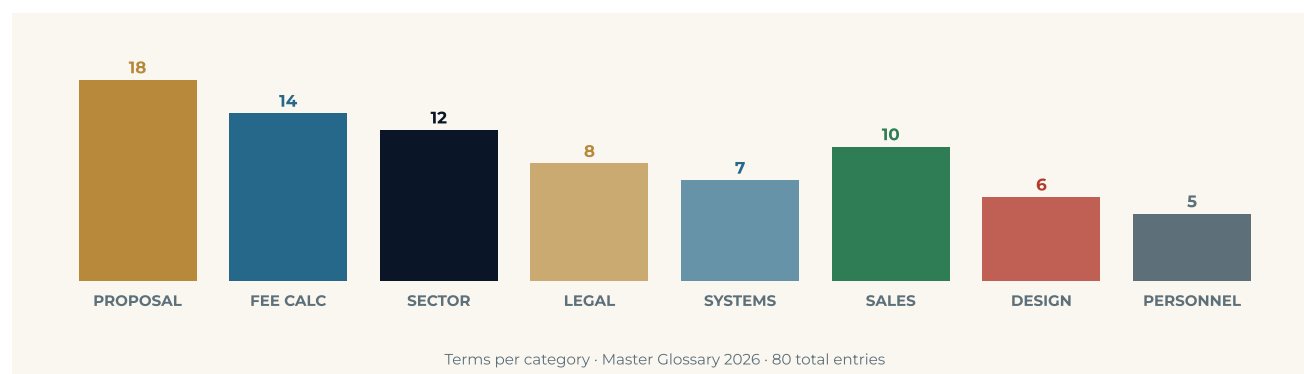
| TAG       | DOMAIN                 | WHAT IT COVERS                                                            |
|-----------|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Proposal  | Proposal Writing       | Document types, structure, narrative rules, submission formats            |
| Fee Calc  | Fee Calculation        | Formulas, rates, SF costs, phase percentages, travel billing              |
| Sector    | Market Sectors         | Client types, segment-specific rules, terminology by industry             |
| Legal     | Contracts & Compliance | Agreement terms, insurance, litigation, variance letters                  |
| Systems   | Tools & Platforms      | Software, CRM, BIM, design tools used at Create The Edge                  |
| Sales     | Business Development   | Conversion, pipeline, marketing, outreach, KPIs                           |
| Design    | Technical Design       | Equipment, kitchen logic, specialty service line sizing, spatial formulas |
| Personnel | Team & Leadership      | Credentials, roles, named individuals at Create The Edge                  |

{ EXPERT INSIGHT

*"Your firm is not selling a product. It is selling the expertise to ask the right questions before the client knows what the right questions are. When architects and owners call you first, it is because you have made yourself indispensable through precision, not personality."*

Create The Edge OS · The Proposal Standard

FIGURE L.1.1 • GLOSSARY DOMAIN DISTRIBUTION



SECTION L • MASTER GLOSSARY • A–C

ALPHABETICAL ENTRIES

## A – C

*From addendum to construction administration, these entries cover the foundational document types, approval workflows, and client-facing terminology that every Create The Edge associate must command from day one.*

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# A

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## Addendum

### PROPOSAL

A formal written modification issued during the bidding phase (Phase IV) that clarifies, corrects, or supplements the construction documents or proposal. All addenda become part of the contract. Issued by Create The Edge during bid review to answer contractor questions or correct errors discovered after document release.

*See also: Phase IV — Bidding/Negotiations · Section G*

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## AIA Agreement

### LEGAL

A standard contract form published by the American Institute of Architects. Some clients and architects send their own AIA agreement in lieu of signing the Create The Edge Consultation Agreement. When received, sign and return it. The AIA agreement supersedes the Create The Edge internal agreement form but does not change the scope or fee structure defined in the proposal.

*See also: Consultation Agreement · Section H*

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## AIA Lunch & Learn (CEU)

### SALES

An American Institute of Architects-approved continuing education presentation delivered by Create The Edge to architect firms, typically over a hosted lunch. Presentations build relationships, establish authority, and generate proposal leads. Current approved topics include A2L refrigerants, food waste disposal systems, sustainable facility design, and kitchen planning fundamentals. Each presentation earns AIA CEU credits for attending architects. Cost to Create The Edge: approximately \$10/day LinkedIn ad spend plus presentation delivery time.

*See also: Business Development · Section A, C*

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## AutoQuotes

### SYSTEMS

The professional services equipment quoting and specification platform used by Create The Edge to estimate equipment costs on projects. AutoQuotes stores historical project records with estimated equipment values, which are used when completing SF 330 forms (the estimated project cost field). It is the primary source for equipment cost validation when writing proposals.

*See also: SF 330 · Section A*

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# B

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## Bid Review

### PROPOSAL

The process during Phase IV (Bidding/Negotiations) in which Create The Edge reviews contractor bids submitted against the construction documents, evaluates alternates, and advises the owner on bid selection. Bid review is one of the most risk-sensitive deliverables: errors here can result in an owner overpaying by tens of thousands of dollars or selecting an unqualified contractor.

*See also: Phase IV · Section G*

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## Bluebeam

### SYSTEMS

PDF collaboration and markup software used by Create The Edge for reviewing construction documents, coordinating with architects and engineers, and managing redline comments. Used in the Implementation Administration phase for submittals and RFI documentation.

*See also: Systems Overview · Section A*

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## Box (Cloud Storage)

### SYSTEMS

The enterprise cloud storage and file-sharing platform used at Create The Edge for storing project files, proposal documents, and completed deliverables. Box serves as the firm's canonical document repository. Associates are expected to save all completed work to the appropriate Box folder for project continuity and team access.

*See also: Systems Overview · Section A*

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## Bullseye (SF 330 Selection Method)

### PROPOSAL

[Department Manager]'s framework for selecting the five past projects submitted on an SF 330. The bullseye means selecting projects that most precisely match the client's request: same architect + same sector + same city or state is the center bullseye. If no bullseye match exists, expand outward to the nearest geographic and sector match. The principle: the client is not evaluating your best projects; they are evaluating your most relevant projects for this specific scope.

*See also: SF 330 · Section G*

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## C

## CA (Implementation Administration)

### PROPOSAL

Phase V of the standard Create The Edge five-phase structure. Represents 18% of the total fee (15% in some sector configurations). Includes submittal review, RFI responses, site inspections (typically one for floor penetrations and one final with written report), and the final punch list. CA is the phase that prevents installation deviation from the approved documents. For correctional projects, CA percentage is increased due to heightened security coordination requirements.

*See also: Five-Phase Structure · Section G, H*

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## Create The Edge (Wordmark Rule)

### PROPOSAL

The firm name is always written in lowercase, bold, and rendered in Create The Edge blue (#266889) in every document. Never capitalized except in the formal legal name CAMACHO ASSOCIATES, INC. within contract language. On dark backgrounds, the name is white and bold. This rule applies without exception in every proposal, training document, email, and marketing asset.

*See also: Brand Standards · All Modules*

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## CD (Project Documents)

### PROPOSAL

Phase III of the five-phase structure. The largest phase at 35% of the total fee. Produces final plans, building condition documentation, elevations, written specifications for bid, and regulatory agency review submissions. The CD phase carries the highest documentation risk of all five phases: errors or omissions discovered here can trigger change orders, contractor disputes, and costly rework. Drawings are produced in Revit at full construction scale with complete MEP coordination.

*See also: Five-Phase Structure · Section G, H*

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## Clash Detection

### DESIGN

The BIM/Revit process of identifying conflicts between different building systems (mechanical, electrical, plumbing, structural, professional services equipment) before construction begins. Create The Edge uses clash detection as a key value differentiator: catching a conflict in a model costs nothing; discovering it after concrete is poured costs tens of thousands. Brett Daniel, FCSI, leads this function as Create The Edge's BIM/Revit Manager.

*See also: BIM/Revit · Section I, G*

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## Consultation Agreement

### LEGAL

The formal contract between Create The Edge and the client, included as the final pages of every fee proposal. Key articles: (I) Associates' duties defined by reference to the proposal; (II) Maximum fee, phase breakdown, net-30 payment terms; (III) Either party may terminate with 7 days written notice, reactivation fee applies after 4+ months suspension; (IV) Client may cancel for non-performance; (V) This agreement supersedes all prior negotiations. No work begins until the authorization page is signed and returned, or an AIA agreement is executed.

*See also: Legal Templates · Section H*

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# Conversion Rate

## SALES

The ratio of proposals submitted to contracts signed. Create The Edge's conversion rate is approximately 1.2:1 (one signed contract for every 1.2 proposals), compared to the industry average of 5:1. This extraordinary hit rate of approximately 80% (vs. 30% industry average) is the quantitative proof that proposal quality, speed, and client relationship depth directly drive revenue. Every improvement to proposal discipline compounds this advantage.

*See also: Sales Metrics · Section C*

### ◉ FROM THE FILES

The conversion rate differential is load-bearing. When [Department Manager] says "we are not a commodity," the 80% hit rate against 30% industry average is the number that proves it. Train yourself to cite it: one contract for every 1.2 proposals is the operational benchmark for the entire sales team.

SECTION L · MASTER GLOSSARY · D–F

## ALPHABETICAL ENTRIES

# D – F

*Discovery, design development, and fee calculation terminology: the vocabulary of scope-setting, client psychology, and the financial instruments that protect Create The Edge on every project.*

# D



## DD (Design Development)

### PROPOSAL

Phase II of the five-phase structure. Represents 25% of the total fee. Produces equipment plans in Revit at 1/4" scale, equipment data books, connection plans, and updated cost estimates. DD is where the schematic concept is resolved into buildable detail, MEP coordination begins, and the client approves the equipment selection before documents go to construction. Errors not caught here surface as costly change orders in Phase III or IV.

*See also: Five-Phase Structure · Section G, H*

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## Decision Drivers ([Department Manager]'s Four)

### SALES

[Department Manager]'s framework for understanding what moves a client to act: (1) Impact — what does completing this project accomplish for the community or organization; (2) Critical Event — what happens if the timeline or budget is missed; (3) Emotional — how will the end-user feel once it is done; (4) Rational — square footage, population, budget, menu preferences. All four must be addressed in the proposal narrative. The emotional and rational drivers are for internal analysis only; these exact words never appear in client-facing text.

*See also: Proposal Narrative · Section D, G*

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## Delivery Markers (30/60/90/100)

### PROPOSAL

Percentage milestones within each phase that define interim deliverable checkpoints on complex or multi-site projects. At 30%, 60%, 90%, and 100% completion of a phase, Create The Edge submits documents for client and architect review. The Major Transportation Hospitality Project engagement used this convention. Each marker triggers a review meeting and, potentially, a progress invoice. Additional meetings beyond the standard count are billed at \$225/hour.

*See also: Phase Structure · Section G*

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## Discovery (Information Gathering)

### SALES

The pre-proposal process of gathering all information required to write an accurate, defensible scope of work. Uses the Work Scope Template (created by Jasmine Wilde) to collect: project name, type, location, client/architect contact, segment, square footage per area, estimated equipment cost, and any specific RFP requirements. [Department Manager]'s principle: a great designer listens first before applying the math. Discovery is the professional act of listening. Rational data (square footage, FTE count, budget) and emotional data (why this project matters, what the end-user needs) are both captured.

*See also: Module E · Information Gathering*

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# E

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## Equipment Budget / Cost Estimate

### FEE CALC

The total estimated cost of all professional services or specialty service line equipment specified for a project, calculated from square footage using the sector rate schedule. This figure is used in two ways: (1) as the base for percentage-method fee calculation (fee = equipment cost × sector percentage); (2) as a required field on SF 330 forms, where AutoQuotes provides the value from historical project records. The estimate is always presented to clients as planning-only; actual cost depends on final specifications and market conditions.

*See also: Fee Calculation · Section H*

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# F

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## FCSI (Professional Services Consultants Society International)

### PERSONNEL

The premier professional organization for professional design consulting consultants. FCSI membership and credential signify peer-validated expertise and adherence to professional standards. FCSI membership on your firm's proposal signals institutional credibility and distinguishes your firm from non-credentialed competitors. List all credentialed personnel with their full designation.

*See also: Leadership · Section A*

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## Fee Chart (Master, 2026)

### FEE CALC

The master reference table of per-square-foot equipment costs and fee percentages by sector. 2026 values: Schools (K-12) \$300–\$325/SF, 4–6% fee; Hospitality \$325/SF, 3.5–5%; Healthcare/Senior Living \$300/SF, 5%; Correctional (under 10,000 SF) \$300/SF, (over 10,000 SF) \$225–\$250/SF, 4–4.5%; Catering/Warming \$200–\$250/SF, 5%; Corporate \$300/SF, 5%; Military 5%; Religious 4.75%. Walk-in Cooler/Freezer \$300/SF; Dishwash \$600/SF; Exhaust Hood \$3,000/linear ft; Serving Line \$2,500/linear ft.

*See also: Fee Calculation · Section H*

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# Fee Proposal

## PROPOSAL

The complete formal document submitted to a client that defines the scope of services, estimated equipment cost, proposed fee, phase breakdown, meeting structure, standard legal language, and the Consultation Agreement. The fee proposal is both a sales document and a legal instrument. It defines Create The Edge's obligations, establishes the fee ceiling, and triggers all subsequent billing. No work begins without a signed fee proposal or executed AIA agreement.

*See also: Proposal Structure · Section G, H*

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## Five-Phase Structure

### PROPOSAL

The standard Create The Edge proposal framework: Phase I SD (20%), Phase II DD (25%), Phase III CD (35%), Phase IV BN (2%), Phase V CA (18%). Total 100%. The phase structure is the fee logic model that defines when work is delivered and when invoices are issued. A 3-phase format (SD/DD combined, CD, CA) is used for smaller or fire-station-type projects. A 6-phase format adds Programming/Equipment Survey before SD for renovations requiring pre-design assessment.

*See also: Section G, H*

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## Flag (Raising a Flag)

### PROPOSAL

[Department Manager]'s term for proactively identifying a problem, gap, or risk in a project's scope and documenting it in the proposal or in a client communication. Flagging is a professional obligation, not a courtesy. Examples: an undersized kitchen identified during drawing review; a scope gap between the architect's program and what Create The Edge can deliver; a code variance required for an unusual design condition. Real Create The Edge flag cases include Star Metals redlines, DeKalb Fire Station scope gap, and Forest Park scope drift.

*See also: Raising Flags · Section G, J*

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## Four Functional Instruments (Proposal Definition)

### PROPOSAL

[Department Manager]'s definitive description of what a Create The Edge proposal is: (1) a Risk Mitigation Instrument — identifies and prevents foreseeable project risks; (2) a Scope Clarity Instrument — defines precisely what Create The Edge will and will not design; (3) a Fee Logic Model — justifies the fee through phase structure, meeting counts, and deliverable detail; (4) a Coordination Assurance Tool — commits Create The Edge's MEP, BIM, and specification coordination process to paper. "It is institutional documentation. It is not a marketing brochure."

*See also: Module G.1 · Proposal Architecture*

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#### { EXPERT INSIGHT

*"The cover letter that opens with credentials is the cover letter that gets skimmed. The cover letter that opens with a precise description of the client's situation — the problem, the timeline, the consequence of inaction — gets read from the first word to the last. Write to their situation. Let the credentials come later."*

*Create The Edge OS · 40 Years in the Room*

SECTION L · MASTER GLOSSARY · G-I

#### ALPHABETICAL ENTRIES

## G – I

*Government contracting forms, independence doctrine, and the compliance vocabulary that underpins Create The Edge's competitive positioning across institutional, federal, and healthcare sectors.*

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## G

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### Hit Rate

#### SALES

The percentage of proposals submitted that result in a signed contract. Create The Edge's hit rate is approximately 80%, compared to an industry average of approximately 30%. This metric is the primary internal proof point for the value of proposal discipline, client relationship investment, and market positioning. A declining hit rate is an early warning signal requiring immediate review of proposal quality, pricing, and target-client alignment.

*See also: Sales Metrics · Section C*

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## H

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## Hourly Rate Schedule (2026)

### FEE CALC

Current billable rates for additional services not covered in the base proposal fee. Project Principal: \$275/hr, \$1,900/day. Senior PM: \$250/hr, \$1,700/day. Project Manager: \$225/hr, \$1,600/day. Quality Control Coordinator: \$200/hr. Project Coordinator: \$150/hr. Revit Operator/BIM Manager: \$160/hr. Specifications Writer: \$120/hr. Administrative Coordinator: \$100/hr. Additional PM meetings (all levels): \$225/hr. Site visit travel: \$1,600/day. These rates are billed for work ordered by the client beyond the contracted scope.

*See also: Rate Schedule · Section H*

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## I

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### IDIQ (Indefinite Delivery, Indefinite Quantity)

#### PROPOSAL

A contract vehicle used primarily by government, healthcare, and school clients where the exact timing and quantity of design services is unknown at the time of award. IDIQ contracts establish a master agreement with pre-negotiated rates and qualifications; specific work is ordered via task orders as projects arise. Create The Edge pursues IDIQ vehicles as a mechanism for long-term institutional relationships where multiple projects are anticipated over a multi-year period.

*See also: Document Types · Section F*

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### Independence (Vendor-Neutral Doctrine)

#### PROPOSAL

The foundational competitive advantage and ethical position of Create The Edge: the firm does not sell equipment, does not accept manufacturer commissions, and is not affiliated with any equipment vendor. This independence allows Create The Edge to specify the best equipment for every application without financial conflict of interest. The independence paragraph appears in every proposal, with sector-specific language: "F&B independence" for hospitality; "Professional Services independence" for education and healthcare. The three pillars: no manufacturer affiliations, no equipment sales, no commissions.

*See also: Vendor-Neutral Statement · Section G, B*

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## Insurance Coverage (Create The Edge 2026)

### LEGAL

Current coverage carried by Create The Edge Associates, Inc.: [Your current coverage limits — update with actual policy amounts]. In [X]+ years of operation and thousands of projects, Create The Edge has [Insert your claims record here. This is a powerful credibility signal — state it accurately.]

*See also: Standard Letters · Section H*

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## Ishikawa Frame (5-Layer Client Analysis)

### SALES

[Department Manager]'s adaptation of the Ishikawa root-cause analysis framework to client decision-making. Applied to sales: surface needs (the stated request) mask deeper rational and emotional drivers. The Kleenex example: buying Kleenex is rational (paper tissue); but the actual driver is protecting your family from germs (emotional). The baby seat example: tires are rational; the baby in the back seat makes it emotional. Identifying the emotional layer beneath the rational request is what separates a transactional proposal from a proposal that wins.

*See also: Client Psychology · Section D*

SECTION L · MASTER GLOSSARY · J–M

### ALPHABETICAL ENTRIES

## J – M

*From JCAHO compliance to the Made/Paid/Loved framework, this range covers the compliance vocabulary of healthcare design and the motivational architecture behind every winning client conversation.*

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**J**

# JCAHO Compliance

## SECTOR

The Joint Commission on Accreditation of Healthcare Organizations standards that govern professional services operations in hospitals and healthcare facilities. JCAHO compliance requirements affect equipment selection, sanitation design, refrigeration reliability, and traffic flow within healthcare kitchens. Create The Edge's healthcare sector work is framed around infection control, refrigeration redundancy, and operational continuity, all of which intersect with JCAHO standards. Louise Howard, Senior Living and Healthcare specialist with 130+ projects since 1996, leads this expertise area.

*See also: Healthcare Sector · Section I*

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# L

## Laundry Sizing Formula (15-Pound Rule)

### DESIGN

The standard method for calculating specialty service line equipment requirements for hotel and institutional projects. Standard hotel: 15 lbs of specialty service line per key per day. Luxury hotel (spa/multiple pools): 20 lbs per key per day. Correctional: 3 lbs per inmate per day. Formula:  $(\text{keys} \times \text{lbs/day}) \div 7 \text{ working hours} = \text{lbs/hour capacity required}$ . Example:  $192 \text{ keys} \times 15 = 2,880 \text{ lbs/day} \div 7 = 412 \text{ lbs/hour}$ . At 200-lb washer capacity with 45-min cycle (267 lbs/hour): 2 washers needed. At 200-lb dryer capacity with 60-min cycle (200 lbs/hour): 3 dryers needed.

*See also: Laundry Design · Section H*

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## Letter of Objective

### PROPOSAL

A formal statement of Create The Edge's intent and approach, required as part of RFP responses. The Letter of Objective describes how Create The Edge will specifically meet the client's goals, why this firm is best positioned for this particular project, and what the client can expect from the engagement. It is distinct from the cover letter (which introduces the firm) and the scope of work (which defines deliverables). The Letter of Objective is the strategic argument for selection.

*See also: RFP Response · Section F, G*

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## Litigation Letter

### LEGAL

A formal certification required by certain government or institutional clients as part of the RFQ or proposal process. Standard language: "Create The Edge is not or has not been involved in any active or pending litigation. Create The Edge does not have any current or former associates involved in any active or pending litigation (within the past five years)." Signed by [Company Owner] C. Create The Edge, FCSI, CSI, President. This letter is pulled from the standard templates folder and updated with the current project name before submission.

*See also: Standard Letters · Section H*

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## M

### Made/Paid/Loved (Client Motivation Framework)

#### SALES

[Department Manager]'s adaptation of Cardone's motivation framework for the professional consulting context. Made: what does this project help the client achieve or create ("graduation rates increase 50% with better nutrition"). Paid: what is the financial return or cost reduction ("ROI via energy reduction," "lower labor cost via zero-step layout"). Loved: what recognition, pride, or relationship value does the client gain ("world-class facility recognition," "recruiting tool for top staff"). All three layers should be present in the proposal narrative, with sector-appropriate language. [Department Manager] describes this as the "softened Cardone" version, calibrated for institutional clients.

*See also: Client Psychology · Section D, G*

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### MasterSpec

#### DESIGN

The industry-standard specification writing system used by Create The Edge for producing the written equipment and installation specifications included in the Project Documents phase. MasterSpec provides the structural framework; Create The Edge's specifications writers customize it for each project's equipment selections, installation requirements, and local code conditions. MEP loads are reviewed in conjunction with MasterSpec to ensure coordination between professional services and mechanical/electrical/plumbing systems.

*See also: Project Documents · Section I*

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The project management platform used by Create The Edge for tracking active projects, deliverable milestones, and team task assignments. Monday.com integrates with the firm's proposal pipeline and provides visibility into project status across all active engagements. Associates are expected to keep their task boards current so project managers have real-time visibility into delivery status.

*See also: Systems Overview · Section A*

### ✓ BEST PRACTICE

The Made/Paid/Loved framework is for internal analysis during proposal drafting. Never write the words "emotionally," "rationally," "critically," or the framework labels themselves in a client-facing document. These are diagnostic tools. The output of the analysis is a well-crafted narrative paragraph, not a labeled framework.

SECTION L · MASTER GLOSSARY · N-R

## ALPHABETICAL ENTRIES

# N – R

*On-call contracting, [CRM Software] pipeline discipline, the pre-flight checklist, and the RFP/RFQ distinction: the operational core of how Create The Edge finds, wins, and executes work.*

# N

## Net 30 (Payment Terms)

### LEGAL

The standard payment term in every Create The Edge Consultation Agreement: payment is due within 30 days of receipt of invoice. Invoices are submitted on the 1st of each month or on agreed-upon dates. Work ordered beyond the contracted scope is billed at the current hourly rate schedule. Late payment is not addressed with a penalty rate in the standard agreement; however, reactivation costs apply if a project is suspended for more than four consecutive months.

*See also: Consultation Agreement · Section H*

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## O

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### On-Call Services Contract

#### PROPOSAL

A pre-established master contract under which Create The Edge is available to begin work immediately as task orders are issued, without requiring a separate proposal process for each project. On-call contracts are common in institutional clients, government agencies, and school districts with ongoing renovation programs. The focus is readiness: the firm is pre-qualified and pre-priced, enabling the client to activate Create The Edge's services on short notice for any qualifying project within the defined scope.

*See also: Document Types · Section F*

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## P

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### Phase I — Conceptual Design (SD)

#### PROPOSAL

The first phase of the Create The Edge standard five-phase structure, representing 20% of the total fee. Deliverables: initial client meetings, space program review, schematic floor plans, preliminary equipment lists, and preliminary cost estimates. SD prevents congestion and oversizing by establishing the fundamental space allocation and equipment strategy before any detailed engineering begins. Standard meetings: 1 in-person with client/architect/design team; 4 Teams/Zoom meetings.

*See also: Five-Phase Structure · Section G, H*

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## [CRM Software]

### SYSTEMS

The CRM (Customer Relationship Management) platform used by Create The Edge to track all proposals, pipeline stages, client communications, and follow-up actions. Every proposal request is logged in [CRM Software] from the moment it is received. Key discipline: the 1–2 paragraph proposal narrative written for each project is saved in the [CRM Software] record, because that text becomes the basis for SF 330 forms, LinkedIn content, and future proposal revisions. Pipeline stages: inquiry received, proposal in progress, proposal sent, signed, declined. Weekly review of unsigned proposals is a standing requirement.

*See also: Proposal Tracking · Section A*

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## Pre-Flight Checklist

### PROPOSAL

The mandatory quality check before any proposal is sent. Items: sector-specific independence paragraph correct; square footage matches FTE and equipment budget; two-paragraph intro only; Letter of Objective included for RFP responses; phase titles accurate; meeting counts confirmed; MasterSpec and MEP loads reviewed; travel line items separated; insurance limits stated (\$2M/\$4M Professional, \$3M/\$6M General, per reference documentation; verify current limits); "Create The Edge" brand name applied consistently; no em dashes; TNR 11pt body/12pt titles (for formal proposals); page 2 justified; flags raised for scope risks; SF 330 selected by bullseye; filed Year-Month-XX.

*See also: Module G.15 · Pre-Flight Checklist*

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## Programming (Pre-Design Report)

### DESIGN

A pre-design phase deliverable distinct from Conceptual Design. Programming produces a written report that synthesizes code requirements, regulatory constraints, FTE/population mathematics, operational flow analysis, and project narrative before any design drawings begin. It is the translation of a client's operational needs into design parameters. Renovations in particular often require a Programming or Equipment Survey phase before Conceptual Design can begin, because the existing conditions must be documented and the new program defined before layout can start.

*See also: Phase Structure · Section G, E*

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**R**

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## Reactivation Fee

### LEGAL

A contractual fee charged when a project that has been suspended for more than four consecutive months is restarted. The reactivation fee compensates Create The Edge for the cost of re-engaging with a project after an extended hiatus: re-reviewing documents, re-coordinating with the team, and reconnecting with the current project status. This provision protects Create The Edge from the common situation where a client pauses a project indefinitely and then expects work to resume at no additional cost.

*See also: Consultation Agreement · Section H*

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## Revit / BIM

### SYSTEMS

Building Information Modeling software used by Create The Edge for producing all construction-quality professional services and specialty design consulting drawings. Equipment plans are produced in Revit at 1/4" scale in Phase II and refined through Phase III. BIM enables 3D clash detection (identifying conflicts with MEP systems before construction), coordination with the architect's and engineer's models, and production of submittal-quality documentation. Brett Daniel, FCSI, serves as Create The Edge's BIM/Revit Manager. Revit families for standard equipment are maintained and updated regularly.

*See also: Systems · Section A, I*

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## RFI (Request for Information)

### PROPOSAL

A formal written question submitted by a contractor to the design team during construction, seeking clarification on the drawings or specifications. Create The Edge receives and responds to RFIs during Phase V (Implementation Administration). RFI response quality directly affects whether the installed work matches the approved design. Inadequate RFI responses are a leading cause of post-construction disputes and punch list items.

*See also: Implementation Administration · Section G*

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## RFP (Request for Proposal)

### PROPOSAL

A solicitation document issued by a client requesting a detailed proposal that addresses the client's specific project objectives. RFP focus: the objective. What the client wants: a decision tool showing exactly how Create The Edge will meet their goals. What Create The Edge submits: fee calculation + Letter of Objective + scope of work structured around the four functional instruments. The RFP response is where the full Create The Edge proposal methodology lives. Unlike an RFQ, an RFP requires a fee; the client is ready to select a firm and negotiate a contract.

*See also: Document Types · Section F*

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# RFQ (Request for Qualifications)

## PROPOSAL

A solicitation document issued by a client requesting proof of competency for a specific scope. RFQ focus: can this firm do this kind of work? What the client wants: evidence of relevant experience for this specific project type, sector, and scale. What Create The Edge submits: resumes, headshots, photos of completed projects, SF 330 forms. The RFQ is a qualification filter, not a contract award. Passing the RFQ moves Create The Edge to the shortlist for an RFP or direct negotiation. [Department Manager]'s note: some clients do not clearly distinguish between RFQ and RFP; read the actual request carefully before responding.

*See also: Document Types · Section F*

### 🔑 RULE OF THE HOUSE

RFQ vs RFP is not always a clear distinction. Some clients issue hybrid documents that contain elements of both. Always read the actual solicitation document before deciding which response format applies. When in doubt, ask [Department Manager]. Submitting a fee proposal in response to a pure RFQ is a disqualifying error at many institutions.

SECTION L · MASTER GLOSSARY · S-Z

## ALPHABETICAL ENTRIES

# S – Z

*SF 330 forms, the SWOT framework, sector vocabulary, travel billing, variance letters, and the work scope template: the final range of the vocabulary that completes your operational command of the Create The Edge system.*

# S

## SD (Conceptual Design)

### PROPOSAL

See: Phase I — Conceptual Design.

*See: Phase I entry above*

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## SF 330

### PROPOSAL

Standard Form 330: the federal government's standard form for architecture and engineering qualifications, required in virtually all government RFQ responses. Two components: SF 330 Part I (resume of key personnel and descriptions of five relevant past projects) and SF 330 Part II (firm statistics: disciplines, employee counts, project types and volumes over five years). To complete Part I efficiently: select five projects using the bullseye method; copy the opening 1–2 paragraphs from the original proposal as the project description; use AutoQuotes for the estimated equipment cost. [Department Manager]'s instruction: "It is a reading test. If we can read, we pass."

*See also: Module G · SF 330*

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## Square Footage (Scope Protection)

### PROPOSAL

The explicit statement of designed square footage in the proposal is not merely descriptive; it is the legal protection for Create The Edge's fee if scope expands. If a project grows from 400 SF to 1,200 SF after the proposal is signed, the written square footage in the proposal document proves what was contracted and gives Create The Edge the right to request additional compensation. Every proposal must state specific square footage for every designed area. Round to whole numbers in written text (438 SF, not 437.86 SF).

*See also: Common Errors · Section G*

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## SWOT Analysis (Meeting Evaluation)

### SALES

Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, Threats: the structured framework used by Create The Edge to evaluate client meetings and prospect situations. Applied after key client interactions to assess relationship health, identify risks in the pursuit strategy, and surface tactical adjustments before the next engagement. A real worked example from a Golf Tournament prospect was developed with [Department Manager] (source: Meeting and Training Notes, [Department Manager] 2026) and appears in Section J with full analysis across all four quadrants.

*See also: Module J · Meeting Evaluation*

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## Travel Billing (50-Mile Rule)

### FEE CALC

Travel costs beyond 50 miles from the Create The Edge [City, State] office are billed as line items separate from the base fee. Day rate for PM site visit: \$1,600/day. Mileage: \$0.665/mile (IRS standard rate, 2026) for private vehicle use beyond the 50-mile radius. Formula: (office to location + location to office) × number of meetings = total miles × \$0.665 = reimbursement amount. Travel costs are never bundled into the base fee; they are explicitly stated as separate line items in the proposal. Failure to separate travel costs is a common proposal error.

*See also: Rate Schedule · Section H*

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## Two-Paragraph Rule (Proposal Narrative)

### PROPOSAL

The structural rule governing the proposal cover letter narrative: the client-facing narrative about the project consists of exactly two paragraphs. Paragraph 1 (context/why): identifies the project's impact, the client's critical event, the emotional decision, and the rational decision. Paragraph 2 (scope/what): describes the design scope, square footage, spaces, and key equipment features. This two-paragraph structure is the most reusable asset in the entire proposal: it becomes the SF 330 project description, the LinkedIn post content, the RFQ narrative, and the reference paragraph for future engagements with the same client.

*See also: Proposal Narrative · Section G*

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## V

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## Variance Letter

### LEGAL

A formal letter sent when a client or implementation team requires insurance coverage limits that exceed what Create The Edge currently carries. The letter requests a waiver or variance based on the limited scope of Create The Edge's services (design drawings and specifications only; no products, no installation, no engineering stamps; site visits limited to 2–3 per project). The letter cites Create The Edge's 57+ year zero-claims record. Signed by: Cathey Create The Edge, CEO. The variance letter is attached to the proposal but does not modify the Consultation Agreement.

*See also: Standard Letters · Section H*

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## Vendor-Neutral Statement

### PROPOSAL

The standard paragraph in every Create The Edge proposal that documents the firm's independence. Standard text: "Create The Edge is not beholden nor tied to any particular manufacturer. We specify the best equipment for the application." Sector-specific versions: hospitality uses "F&B independence"; education and healthcare use "Professional Services independence." This paragraph is a non-negotiable component of every proposal and serves as a legal declaration of the firm's conflict-free status.

*See also: Independence Doctrine · Section B, G*

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## W

## WKU FEED Program

### SALES

Western Kentucky University's Professional Services Equipment and Design program, a university-level training pipeline for entry-level professional consultants. Create The Edge recruits from this program (Haley is a named graduate on the current team) and uses it as a marketing vehicle: producing testimonial content that lifts up WKU/FEED while organically highlighting Create The Edge as a premier employer and training ground in the field. This is [Department Manager]'s "backwards approach" to sales: promote the program to promote the firm without making it about the firm.

*See also: Business Development · Section C*

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## Work Scope Template

### PROPOSAL

The standardized form created by Jasmine Wilde used to gather all project information before writing a proposal. Fields: project name, type (new construction or remodel), location, client/architect name/title/firm/address/phone/email, project segment, square footage per area, estimated equipment cost, and specific notes or RFP requirements from the inquiry email. Completing this form before writing any proposal text ensures the narrative and fee calculation are grounded in verified information, not assumptions.

*See also: Discovery · Section E*

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The square footage in your proposal is your protection. If Forest Park Recreation Center grows from a catering kitchen to a full production facility after signing, the square footage you wrote down in the proposal is what was contracted and what triggers your right to additional compensation. Never omit it; never approximate it. Write the number, round it to whole digits, and keep it in the [CRM Software] record.

## 15-Question Assessment

*Questions progress from vocabulary recall through applied judgment. No answers appear on this page. Refer to the Answer Legend on the following pages after completing all 15 questions.*

1

A Create The Edge proposal is defined as four functional instruments. Which of the following is NOT one of the four?

- ☐ A Risk Mitigation Instrument
- ☐ B Scope Clarity Instrument
- ☐ C Brand Authority Document
- ☐ D Coordination Assurance Tool

2

What is Create The Edge's approximate hit rate on submitted proposals, compared to the industry average?

- ☐ A 50% Create The Edge vs. 30% industry
- ☐ B 80% Create The Edge vs. 30% industry
- ☐ C 80% Create The Edge vs. 50% industry
- ☐ D 65% Create The Edge vs. 40% industry

3

Using the standard specialty service line sizing formula, a 200-key hotel at 15 lbs/key/day requires how many lbs/hour capacity?

- ☐ A 200 lbs/hour
- ☐ B 286 lbs/hour
- ☐ C 412 lbs/hour
- ☐ D 428 lbs/hour

4

The "bullseye" concept in SF 330 selection means:

- ☐ A Submit your five highest-revenue past projects
- ☐ B Submit the five most recent projects regardless of sector
- ☐ C Submit the most relevant projects by sector, architect, and geography
- ☐ D Submit only projects with the same client contact name

5

Which phase of the five-phase structure carries the highest documentation risk and represents the largest fee percentage?

- ☐ A Phase I — Conceptual Design (20%)
- ☐ B Phase II — Design Development (25%)
- ☐ C Phase III — Project Documents (35%)
- ☐ D Phase V — Implementation Administration (18%)

6

A client requests insurance coverage limits beyond what Create The Edge carries. The correct response is to:

- ☐ A Decline the project
- ☐ B Increase coverage and absorb the cost
- ☐ C Issue a variance letter signed by Cathey Create The Edge, CEO
- ☐ D Issue a variance letter signed by Company Owner, President

7

In the Made/Paid/Loved framework, which statement represents the "Paid" dimension for a K-12 school project?

- ☐ A "Graduation rates increase 50% with better nutrition"
- ☐ B "A world-class facility will become a recruiting tool for top staff"
- ☐ C "ROI via energy reduction and lower labor cost via zero-step layout"
- ☐ D "Students will feel pride using a modern cafeteria"

8

What is the travel billing rate for a site visit beyond 50 miles from the [City, State] office?

- ☐ A \$1,275/day
- ☐ B \$1,500/day
- ☐ C \$1,600/day
- ☐ D \$225/hour only, no day rate

9

The vendor-neutral statement in a Create The Edge proposal serves what primary legal purpose?

- ☐ A It limits Create The Edge's liability for equipment failures
- ☐ B It declares Create The Edge's conflict-free, commission-free status in writing
- ☐ C It prevents the client from substituting equipment after the proposal is signed
- ☐ D It waives Create The Edge's responsibility for contractor selection

10

An RFQ differs from an RFP primarily in that an RFQ:

- ☐ A Requires a fee calculation and Letter of Objective
- ☐ B Is used only for government projects
- ☐ C Focuses on proof of competency, not project approach or fee
- ☐ D Is always followed by contract award without further competition

11

The square footage stated in a proposal is important beyond description because:

- ☐ A It determines which insurance tier applies
- ☐ B It legally defines the contracted scope and protects Create The Edge's right to request additional fees if scope expands
- ☐ C It must match the architect's program exactly or the proposal is void
- ☐ D It is required only for government submissions

12

Which statement about the Consultation Agreement is accurate?

- ☐ A Work may begin once the proposal is emailed, before signature
- ☐ B Either party may terminate with 14 days written notice
- ☐ C A project suspended more than 4 consecutive months triggers a reactivation fee
- ☐ D Payment is due net 60 days from invoice receipt

13

Clash detection in a BIM/Revit model primarily prevents:

- ☐ A Equipment specification errors during Phase I
- ☐ B Contractor disputes about bid alternates in Phase IV
- ☐ C Conflicts between professional services and MEP systems discovered only after concrete is poured
- ☐ D Client requests for scope changes in Phase V

14

[Department Manager]'s Ishikawa framework applied to client sales means:

- ☐ A Mapping five root causes of project failure before writing the proposal
- ☐ B Identifying the emotional layer beneath the client's stated rational request
- ☐ C Applying a cause-and-effect diagram to the project schedule
- ☐ D Documenting all stakeholder objections in a fishbone format

15

The two-paragraph proposal narrative rule produces a document that is reused for all of the following EXCEPT:

- ☐ A SF 330 project description fields
- ☐ B LinkedIn post content
- ☐ C Billing invoice line items
- ☐ D Future RFQ responses for the same client

## Answer Legend — Questions 1–8

### QUESTION 1

**Correct: C • Brand Authority Document**

*The four instruments are: Risk Mitigation, Scope Clarity, Fee Logic Model, and Coordination Assurance. A proposal is institutional documentation, not a marketing brochure. Ref: L.1, Module G.1*

### QUESTION 2

**Correct: B • 80% Create The Edge vs. 30% industry**

*Create The Edge's 1.2:1 conversion ratio (approx. 80% hit rate) versus the industry's 5:1 (approx. 30%) is the quantitative proof of proposal discipline. Ref: Conversion Rate entry, Section C*

#### QUESTION 3

**Correct: D · 428 lbs/hour**

*200 keys × 15 lbs = 3,000 lbs/day ÷ 7 hours = 428.6 lbs/hour, rounded to 428. (The 192-key example in the training manual yields 412 lbs/hour; 200 keys yields the higher figure.) Ref: Laundry Sizing Formula entry, Section H*

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#### QUESTION 4

**Correct: C · Most relevant by sector, architect, geography**

*The bullseye selects for relevance, not revenue or recency. Same architect + same sector + same location is the center. Ref: Bullseye entry, Section G*

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#### QUESTION 5

**Correct: C · Phase III — Project Documents (35%)**

*CD carries both the highest fee percentage and the highest documentation risk. Errors here drive contractor disputes and costly change orders. Ref: CD entry, Five-Phase Structure, Section G*

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#### QUESTION 6

**Correct: C · Variance letter signed by Cathey Create The Edge, CEO**

*The variance letter is signed by the CEO (Cathey Create The Edge), not the President. This is a common detail error. Ref: Variance Letter entry, Section H*

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#### QUESTION 7

**Correct: C · ROI via energy reduction and lower labor cost**

*"Paid" = financial return. A is "Made" (achievement). B and D are "Loved" (recognition/feeling). Ref: Made/Paid/Loved entry, Section D*

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#### QUESTION 8

**Correct: C · \$1,600/day**

*The PM site visit day rate beyond 50 miles from [Company HQ] is \$1,600/day, billed as a separate line item from the base fee. Mileage at \$0.665/mile is additional. Ref: Travel Billing entry, Section H*

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## Answer Legend — Questions 9–15

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#### QUESTION 9

**Correct: B · Declares Create The Edge's conflict-free, commission-free status in writing**

*The vendor-neutral statement is a legal declaration, not just brand positioning. It documents independence on the record, protecting both the firm and the client. Ref: Vendor-Neutral Statement entry, Section G*

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#### QUESTION 10

**Correct: C · Focuses on proof of competency, not approach or fee**

*RFQ = qualifications (who you are). RFP = proposal (what you will do and for how much). Both may be issued by any client type, not only government. Ref: RFQ/RFP entries, Section F*

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#### QUESTION 11

**Correct: B · Defines contracted scope; protects right to additional fees**

*Square footage in the proposal is the scope boundary. When a project expands beyond the stated SF, Create The Edge can invoke this figure to justify additional service compensation. Ref: Square Footage entry, Section G*

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#### QUESTION 12

**Correct: C · 4-month suspension triggers reactivation fee**

*Termination notice is 7 days (not 14). Payment is net 30 (not 60). Work does not begin before signature. The 4-month suspension/reactivation clause is the accurate provision. Ref: Consultation Agreement entry, Section H*

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#### QUESTION 13

**Correct: C · Conflicts between professional services and MEP discovered after concrete is poured**

*Clash detection is the pre-construction process of finding MEP/structural conflicts in the model before they become expensive field problems. Ref: Clash Detection entry, Section I*

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#### QUESTION 14

**Correct: B · Identifying the emotional layer beneath the rational request**

*Ishikawa applied to sales: the stated need (rational) masks the real driver (emotional). The baby seat and Kleenex examples both illustrate this. Ref: Ishikawa entry, Section D*

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Correct: C · Billing invoice line items

The two-paragraph narrative is reused for SF 330s, LinkedIn content, future RFQs, and [CRM Software] records. It is not used as billing invoice language. Ref: Two-Paragraph Rule entry, Section G

STUDY TOOLS

# Flashcard Reference Grid

12 key term-to-definition pairs for rapid review. Use the grid for quick scanning; use the interactive flip cards below for active recall practice.

| # | TERM                        | DEFINITION / KEY FACT                                                                                                                | SECTION |
|---|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| 1 | Four Functional Instruments | Risk Mitigation, Scope Clarity, Fee Logic Model, Coordination Assurance. "Institutional documentation, not a marketing brochure."    | G       |
| 2 | Hit Rate                    | Create The Edge ~80% (1.2:1 ratio) vs. industry ~30% (5:1 ratio). Primary proof of proposal discipline value.                        | C       |
| 3 | Five-Phase Structure        | SD 20% / DD 25% / CD 35% / BN 2% / CA 18%. CD is largest and highest-risk phase.                                                     | G, H    |
| 4 | Bullseye (SF 330)           | Select past projects by: same architect + same sector + same location. Most relevant, not best or most recent.                       | G       |
| 5 | Laundry Formula             | Keys × 15 lbs ÷ 7 hrs = lbs/hour. Standard hotel = 15 lbs/key/day. Luxury = 20 lbs. Correctional = 3 lbs/inmate.                     | H       |
| 6 | Made/Paid/Loved             | Made = achievement/impact. Paid = ROI/cost savings. Loved = recognition/pride. Internal framework; never label these in client text. | D       |

| #  | TERM                          | DEFINITION / KEY FACT                                                                                                                           | SECTION |
|----|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| 7  | <b>Travel Billing</b>         | \$1,600/day site visit + \$0.665/mile beyond 50 miles from [City, State]. Always a separate line item; never bundled into base fee.             | H       |
| 8  | <b>Variance Letter</b>        | Sent when client requires coverage beyond Create The Edge's policy. Signed by Cathey Create The Edge, CEO. Cites [X]+ years zero-claims record. | H       |
| 9  | <b>Consultation Agreement</b> | 7 days notice to terminate. Net 30 payment. Reactivation fee after 4-month suspension. No work before signature.                                | H       |
| 10 | <b>RFQ vs RFP</b>             | RFQ = qualifications/competency proof. RFP = proposal with fee and approach. Some clients issue hybrids; always read the actual document.       | F       |
| 11 | <b>Two-Paragraph Rule</b>     | Context (why/impact/critical event/emotional/rational) + Scope (what/SF/spaces/equipment). Reused for SF 330, LinkedIn, future RFQs.            | G       |
| 12 | <b>Independence Doctrine</b>  | No manufacturer affiliations, no equipment sales, no commissions. "Create The Edge is not beholden nor tied to any particular manufacturer."    | B, G    |

SECTION L · MASTER GLOSSARY · INTERACTIVE FLASHCARDS

STUDY TOOLS · SCREEN ONLY

## Interactive Flip Cards

*Click or tap any card to reveal the definition. Use the navigation buttons to move through all 12 cards. Active recall practice is significantly more effective than passive re-reading.*

TERM — CLICK TO FLIP

## Four Functional Instruments

Click card to flip · Use buttons to navigate

← PREV



NEXT →

SECTION L · MASTER GLOSSARY · PRINTABLE STUDY CARDS

STUDY TOOLS · PRINT-READY

## Printable Cut Cards

*Print this page, cut along the dashed borders, and use as physical study cards. Navy side = term; white side = definition.*

### Four Functional Instruments

Risk Mitigation · Scope Clarity · Fee Logic Model  
· Coordination Assurance. Not a marketing brochure.

### Hit Rate

Create The Edge ~80% (1.2:1) vs. industry ~30% (5:1). Proof of proposal discipline value.

### Five-Phase Structure

SD 20% / DD 25% / CD 35% / BN 2% / CA 18%. CD is largest and highest-risk.

### Bullseye (SF 330)

Same architect + same sector + same location. Most relevant, not best or most recent.

### Laundry 15-Lb Rule

Keys × 15 lbs ÷ 7 hrs = lbs/hour. Luxury = 20 lbs/key. Correctional = 3 lbs/inmate.

### Made/Paid/Loved

Made = impact. Paid = ROI. Loved = recognition. Internal framework; never label in client text.

### Travel Billing

\$1,600/day + \$0.665/mile beyond 50 miles from [City, State]. Always a separate line item.

### Variance Letter

Signed by Cathey Create The Edge, CEO. Cites 57+ year zero-claims record. Attached to proposal but does not modify the agreement.

### Consultation Agreement

7-day termination notice. Net 30 payment.  
Reactivation fee after 4-month suspension. No work before signature.

### RFQ vs RFP

RFQ = qualifications proof. RFP = fee + approach proposal. Always read the actual document; some are hybrids.

### Two-Paragraph Rule

Para 1: context/why/impact. Para 2: scope/what/SF. Reused for SF 330, LinkedIn, future RFQs.

### Independence Doctrine

No manufacturer ties. No equipment sales. No commissions. "Not beholden nor tied to any particular manufacturer."